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Glen Osborne man wants to expand cycling opportunities in Sewickley Valley



Kristina Serafini | Sewickley Herald

In this file photo, a bicyclist rides along Broad Street in Sewickley. A Glen Osborne resident wants to create a more bike-friendly community.

By **Bobby Cherry**

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John Orndorff envisions a day when cyclists can ride from Monaca to Sewickley, or from points south along the Montour Trail, through Coraopolis and cross the Sewickley Bridge.

The Glen Osborne resident said he doesn't consider himself an avid cyclist, but with several rails-to-trails programs happening near the Sewickley Valley, Orndorff said he wants to see cyclists enjoy those opportunities here.

"My goal is to make the Beaver Road corridor a more safe and more friendly bicycle way," said Orndorff, a Sewickley Valley Community Fund board member who is seeking other residents to initiate a cycling

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advocacy group in an effort to create bike lanes along Beaver Road and Beaver Street through Glen Osborne, Sewickley, Edgeworth and Leetsdale.

He also wants to offer connecting paths along other roadways leading into Sewickley Heights, Bell Acres and Leet Township.

Orndorff said he has attended meetings of the Ohio River Trail Council — a Beaver County-based nonprofit group seeking to extend bike and water access around the Beaver Valley.

The group has proposed a bike path from Monaca into Moon and Coraopolis that would link to the Montour Trail.

“We’re sort of losing out in terms of getting any bike traffic,” Orndorff said.

A proposal to extend a path across the Ohio River in Ambridge and head south could help link the path to the Sewickley Valley and cross the Sewickley Bridge connecting to the Montour Trail, Orndorff said.

“Bike traffic brings customers into the Sewickley community,” he said. “It also brings potential residents in. It’s a good reason to link us into what (the Ohio River Trail Council) has already done.”

No plans have been proposed to local governments for creating bike lanes, but Orndorff said adding bike-friendly access is possible.

“The nicest option is to have a dedicated bike lane,” he said.

Orndorff said bike lanes in the Sewickley Valley eventually could spur community events for “cyclists to raise money for worthy causes, challenge individuals to improve physical fitness, encourage safe cycling habits and raise community awareness of cycling as a healthy form of transportation.”

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